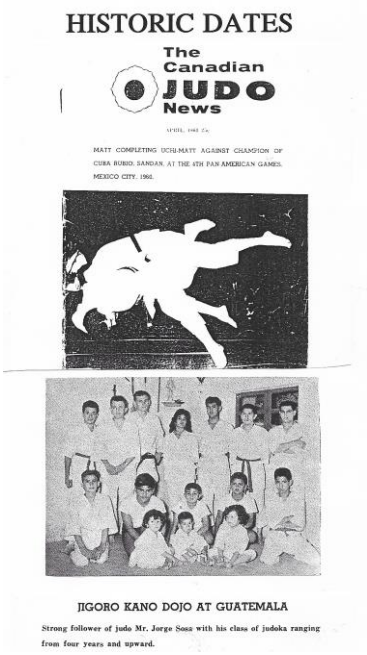
HISTORY AND LEGACY OF WORLD UNION BUDŌ SOSA-KAI

A journey through our origins, evolution, teachings, and commitment to Budō.

I. The Beginnings of the Master

The foundation of our organization is rooted in the spirit, dedication, and vision of our Master, **Daishi Jorge Sosa Sr.**, who, at the age of 17, began his Path in the martial arts. On **April 4, 1943**, he began his training in Jujitsu or Jūjutsu under the guidance of **Sensei Silvestre Méndez**, in his hometown of **Quetzaltenango, Guatemala**. He maintained a consistent practice for approximately three years and later, due to circumstances in his life, moved to Guatemala City, where he continued his martial arts training.
After six years of practicing Jujitsu, around **1949**, he traveled to **San Antonio, Texas**, where he had the opportunity to receive training in **Kodokan Judō**. Upon returning to Guatemala, he established his first **Dōjō** in the Barrio Moderno neighborhood of Guatemala City. He later established his headquarters at **12 Avenida 3-01 and 3rd Street, Zone 1**, where he founded the **Dōjō Jigoro Kano**. Several months later, he participated in the founding of the **first Judō Federation** in Guatemala. His profound dedication, discipline, and perseverance in the practice of Judō led him to attain the rank of **Black Belt on December 22, 1962**, after being examined by **Sensei Eli Cabeiro**, a 4th Dan in Kodokan Judō of Cuban origin. Throughout his years of Judō practice, our Master also had the opportunity to train under several distinguished instructors, including **Sensei Peter Zpats of Germany, and Yasuo Nakayama and Hironori Seki, both of Japan**.


HISTORIC DATES

The Canadian JUDO News

MATT COMPLETING UCHI-MATT AGAINST CHAMPION OF CUBA RUBIO, SANDAN, AT THE 4TH PAN AMERICAN GAMES. MEXICO CITY, 1966.

JIGORO KANO DOJO AT GUATEMALA

Strong follower of judo Mr. Jorge Sosa with his class of judoka ranging from four years and upward.



The Encounter with Shitō-Ryū KarateDō

In **1961**, through the introduction of **Master Yasuo Nakayama** of Judō, our Master was introduced to **Master Nobuyoshi Murata**, a distinguished exponent of **Shitō-Ryū KarateDō** and leader of the **Mexican KarateDō Association**. This encounter marked the beginning of a new stage in his martial arts journey: the beginning of his training in **KarateDō**.



The Mexican KarateDō Association: Some of the people in the picture: Cintas Negras: Alejandro Frías, Juan Jorge Farias, Sensei Héctor Aguirre, Manuel Mondragón, Carlos Vila, Saiko-Shihan Nobuyoshi Murata, Daishi Jorge Sosa Sr., Mrs. Ana María Sosa & Yukiko Murata.

From that moment forward, he embarked on a demanding process of learning, practice, and assimilation of the **Shitō-Ryū style**, under the guidance of **Saikō-Shihan Nobuyoshi Murata** and, subsequently, **Nidaime Kenei Mabuni**, the eldest son of the founder of Shitō-Ryū, the great Master **Kenwa Mabuni**.



Daishi Jorge Sosa Sr.'s Early KarateDō Training with Nidaime Kenei Mabuni, Mexico, 1962

This period represented a fundamental moment in the evolution of his martial arts journey and laid the foundation for what, over the years, would become the tradition and legacy that World Budō Sosa-Kai represents today.



Left to right: Saiko-Shihan Nobuyoshi Murata, Nidaime Kenei Mabuni & Daishi Jorge Sosa Sr.



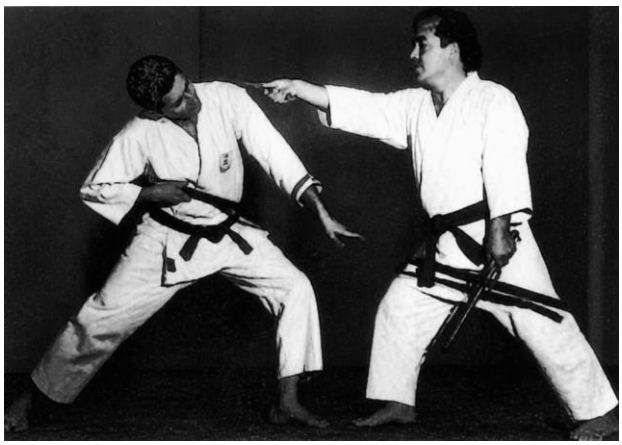
First row, left to right: Hanshi Masatoshi Nakayama, Nidaime Kenei Mabuni, Hanshi Teruyuki Okazaki, and Daishi Jorge Sosa Sr.

II. Martial Arts Training and Development

It was at this point that our Master began his Path of **Dō**, under the supervision, guidance, and direction of these two great masters, initially through the study and assimilation of **KarateDō**, and subsequently through the study of other traditional Japanese martial arts. It is important to note that, during that period, the **Sensei** would transmit certain techniques and **Kata** only to those students who demonstrated the aptitude, attitude, discipline, and commitment necessary to follow the true Path of **Budō**. This method of instruction reflected, to a significant extent, the traditional methods of transmission found in the martial arts of **Japan**, particularly in **Okinawa**, where certain knowledge was historically transmitted selectively to members of particular families or to students considered worthy of receiving it. It was within this context that **Nidaime Kenei Mabuni** chose our Master to receive a broader and deeper education, not only in **KarateDō**, but also in other traditional disciplines, including **Ryū-Kyū Kobudō, Iaidō, Ninpō, and Tai-Jutsu**.
Master Kenei Mabuni made several trips to **Guatemala** to continue transmitting his knowledge. On three of these occasions, he remained in the country for an entire year, allowing our Master and his sons to receive a significant part of his teachings directly and to assimilate firsthand the technical material transmitted by Master Mabuni. These periods of shared residence, training, and direct instruction constituted a fundamental stage in our Master's martial arts development and contributed decisively to the consolidation of a tradition that, through successive generations, continues to form an essential part of the legacy of **World Budō Sosa-Kai.**



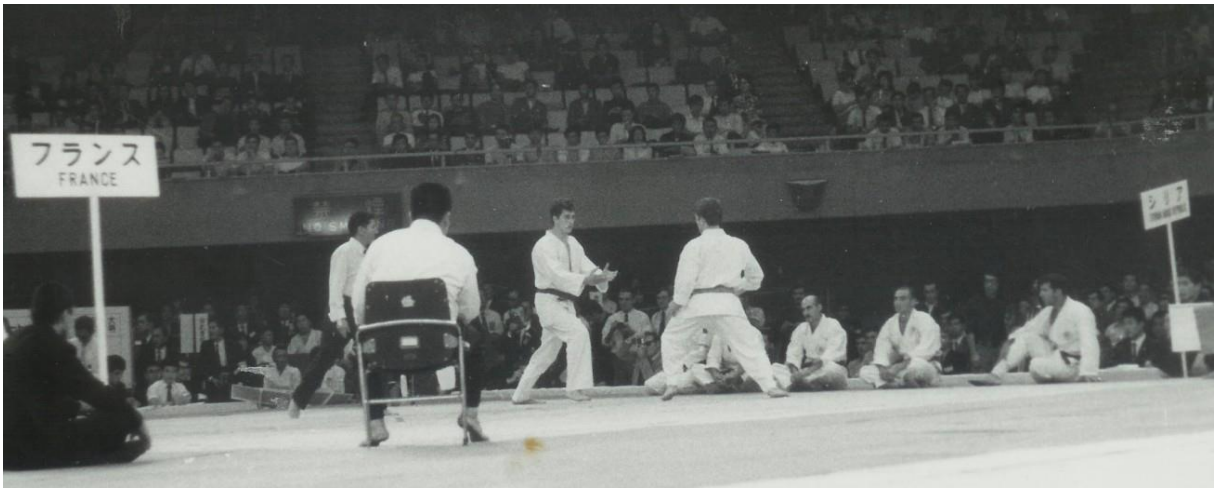
Kendō: Nidaime Mabuni – Daishi Sosa Sr.


Ryū Kyū Kobudō : Sai vs. Bo

III. The Birth of Our Organization

Thus, over the years, as our Master received, studied, and assimilated this knowledge, the five Martial Arts that are currently part of our organization's teaching gradually became established. Each of them represents an important part of the legacy and training transmitted throughout this Path of **Budō**.
As is widely recognized within the world of Martial Arts, Sōke Kenwa Mabuni was a true authority and an extraordinary source of knowledge concerning **Budō**. Numerous masters and practitioners sought his

guidance to consult with him, deepen their understanding, and clarify their knowledge regarding the practice and principles of the Martial Arts. The opportunity to receive this tradition directly and to have access to the knowledge transmitted through the lineage of Kenwa Mabuni, particularly through **Nidaime Kenei Mabuni**, constituted a fundamental source for our Master's training and, subsequently, for the development of our organization. In this way, the knowledge received did not remain merely as a historical inheritance; rather, it was **practiced, studied, developed, and transmitted** to subsequent generations, giving rise to the martial identity and legacy that **World Budō Sosa-Kai** represents today.



Daishi Jorge Sosa Sr. refereeing a team Kumite match in Tokyo, Japan, 1970.



参 加 証

審判員 ソーサ. J. 殿

あなたは第一回世界空手道選手権大会に参加したことを証します

昭和45年10月13日

第一回世界空手道選手権大会

会長 笹川良一

CERTIFICATE October 13, 1970

This is to certify that J. SOSA has participated in the First World Karate-do Championship Tournament, held in Tokyo and Osaka, Japan, from October 10 to 13, 1970.

TO: Mr. J. Sosa
Judge

Ryoichi Sasakawa
President
The First World Karate-do Championship Tournament

Daishi Jorge Sosa Sr., the first internationally recognized referee in the Americas, Japan, 1970.



Founders of the World Union KarateDō Organizations (W.U.K.O.) 1970 - Japan
Daishi Jorge Sosa Sr., second row — Guatemala



Members of the Referee Examination Committee in Paris, France, 1972: Jorge Sosa Sr., Manzo Iwata, Masatoshi Nakayama, Ryoichi Sasakawa, and Hidetaka Nishiyama.

IV. Evolution of Practice and Teaching

As our Master acquired and deepened his knowledge of the various Martial Arts, he progressively incorporated them into his training, demonstrations, and teaching activities in Guatemala. The introduction of **KarateDō** represented something truly new in the country and, through his dedication and continuous work, he eventually had approximately **21 Dōjōs** under his supervision. As part of his demonstrations and martial arts activities, he presented on various occasions the disciplines of **Ryū-Kyū Kobudō, Kendō, Iaidō, and Tai-Jutsu**, introducing the public to the richness and diversity of the Japanese Martial Arts. On some occasions, tournaments even included a special **Ryū-Kyū Kobudō** category, in which competitions featuring **Kata of Bō-Jutsu, Sai-Jutsu, and Nunchaku-Jutsu** were held. In **1990**, these five Martial Arts—**KarateDō, Ryū-Kyū Kobudō, Iaidō, Tai-Jutsu, and Ninpō**—were introduced in the city of **Lethbridge, Alberta, Canada**. Their teaching generated great interest and attracted significant participation from the Canadian community, marking the beginning of a new stage of expansion and development for our organization beyond Guatemala. Later, in 2001, the teaching of these Martial Arts expanded to the cities of **Newark, Fontana, Beaumont, and Moreno Valley**, in California, United States. In this way, the knowledge and experience accumulated over decades of practice began to take root in new territories, progressively expanding the presence and reach of our organization. This evolution represented not only the geographical expansion of our teaching, but also the continuation of a **Path of Life**, through which the Martial Arts received and developed by our Master were transmitted to new generations of practitioners.






V. The Formation of Sosa-Kai

Formally, **Sosa-Kai** was established in **2001**, during a meeting held by **Daishi Jorge Sosa Sr**. and his sons, **Hugo Yasuo Sosa and Jorge Sosa Jr.** This meeting marked the beginning of a new era in the evolution of our organization and in the continuation of the legacy transmitted by our Master. From that moment forward, **Sosa-Kai** entered a new stage of development and expansion, dedicated to sharing its knowledge and teachings in different countries. Its presence progressively extended to **Mexico, Argentina, and Guatemala**, strengthening the bonds among the various groups and practitioners who shared this vision of **Budō**. By that time, groups had already been established in **Canada and the United States**, which became an essential part of this new stage of international growth. Thus began the consolidation of **Sosa-Kai** as an organization dedicated to preserving, developing, and transmitting the Martial Arts received through our Master, with respect for tradition, discipline, and the **Path of Dō** as its foundation.

VI. International Expansion and Development

The work and dedication continued, and **Sosa-Kai** entered a new stage of international expansion. Over time, our organization extended its presence and teachings to different regions of the world, establishing connections with practitioners and groups who share our vision of **Budō**. This expansion reached countries across the Americas, Asia, and other regions, progressively incorporating **Costa Rica, India, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Brazil, Colombia, Nicaragua, and Chile**. In this way, the work begun decades ago by our Master continues to transcend borders, bringing the knowledge, principles, and values of the Martial Arts to new places and strengthening the international presence of **Sosa-Kai**.

VII. Our Philosophy and Principles

Philosophy

At **World Budō Sosa-Kai**, we believe that **Budō** is much more than a system of self-defense, a sport discipline, or a merely physical activity. **Budō** is a **Path of Life** that invites us to pursue personal growth, continuous self-improvement, and the harmonious development of the **body, mind, and spirit**. Through constant practice, Budō teaches us to transform difficulties into opportunities for learning, mistakes into experiences for growth, and challenges into means of strengthening our character. The true purpose of practice is not limited to the Dōjō; its teachings should accompany us and be reflected in every aspect of our lives.

Principles
We promote **respect for oneself and others, courtesy, humility, honesty, discipline, perseverance, and a sense of responsibility.** These values constitute the foundations upon which our practice of **Budō** should be developed. They should not remain solely within the Dōjō, but should be reflected in our daily conduct: within the family, at work, at school, in the community, and in all our human relationships. For **World Budō Sosa-Kai**, practicing **Budō** means embracing a permanent commitment to our own development while, at the same time, contributing to the well-being and growth of those around us. In this way, the **Path of Dō** becomes a way of living, learning, and serving others.

VIII. Legacy and the New Generations

We have the responsibility and commitment to **preserve, develop, and transmit** to future generations the knowledge and teachings received through the legacy of the great Master **Kenwa Mabuni** and the tradition that was passed down to our Master. We understand that this legacy consists not only of transmitting martial techniques and knowledge. It represents the continuation of a **Path of Life** that seeks the integral development of the human being through study and practice encompassing the **physical, mental, spiritual, and intellectual dimensions**. Our mission is to keep this tradition alive, to enrich it through the study and experience acquired over the years, and to transmit it with responsibility, respect, and authenticity to future generations, so that they may continue walking this **Path of Dō** and, in turn, become future custodians and transmitters of this legacy.

IX. Our Vision for the Future

One of the principal goals and aspirations of World Budō Sosa-Kai is to train **professionals in the field of the Martial Arts**, capable of assuming, with responsibility, knowledge, and ethics, the mission of transmitting **Budō** to future generations. Our vision is that every practitioner who attains the rank of **Black Belt** should possess not only the technical proficiency appropriate to their level, but also the knowledge, discipline, maturity, and preparation necessary to lead and educate future generations in a **professional, responsible, and humane manner**. We believe that the Martial Arts can offer humanity a different way of understanding life, contributing to the development of **better human beings** and individuals who are capable of making a positive contribution to the society in which they live.

Just as other professions prepare specialists who place their knowledge at the service of society—such as physicians, lawyers, engineers, educators, and professionals in the various fields of society—we believe that the **field of the Martial Arts** can and should also have properly prepared professionals who carry out their work with seriousness, knowledge, ethics, and commitment. For this reason, **World Budō Sosa-Kai** aspires to develop a system of education and training that goes beyond technical instruction, preparing future instructors and leaders to assume the responsibilities inherent in a profession dedicated to the integral development of the human being. Our vision for the future is therefore to **develop Budō professionals capable of transmitting knowledge, cultivating values, developing character, and contributing to the building of a better society**, while keeping alive the true spirit of the **Path of Dō** for present and future generations.